



8/13/2026

# ASSIGNMENT DAY 3

BIOS and POST Error Analysis &  
Troubleshooting.

## TASK 1.

- ❖ List 5 common BIOS or POST error messages you might see when starting a PC and write what hardware or configuration issue each one usually points to.

➤ Common BIOS/POST Error Messages:

| <u>BIOS/POST Error Message</u> | <u>Usually Indicates</u>                        |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| CMOS Checksum Error            | Incorrect or corrupted BIOS/CMOS settings       |
| Keyboard Error                 | Keyboard is disconnected or faulty              |
| Memory Error                   | RAM is loose, faulty, or not detected           |
| Disk Boot Failure              | Boot drive is missing or not detected           |
| CPU Fan Error                  | CPU fan is disconnected or not working properly |

## TASK 2.

- ❖ Set up a local printer (USB or network), install the correct driver, and print a test page to confirm successful installation.

➤ AMI BIOS 3-Beep Error:

➤ **Meaning:** Three short beeps usually indicate a base 64K RAM failure, meaning the system cannot properly detect or test the memory.

#### **Troubleshooting Steps:**

- Reseat the RAM: Remove the RAM stick, clean the contacts gently, and insert it firmly again.
- Test the RAM: Try booting with one RAM stick at a time or test with a known-working RAM stick.

## **TASK 3.**

❖ **Access the BIOS setup utility on any available PC or virtual machine, take a screenshot of the main BIOS screen, and identify the motherboard manufacturer and BIOS version.**

#### ➤ **BIOS Setup Utility:**

 **Explanation:** I accessed the BIOS Setup Utility and opened the main BIOS screen to check the system information.

🔄 The screenshot is shown on the next page.

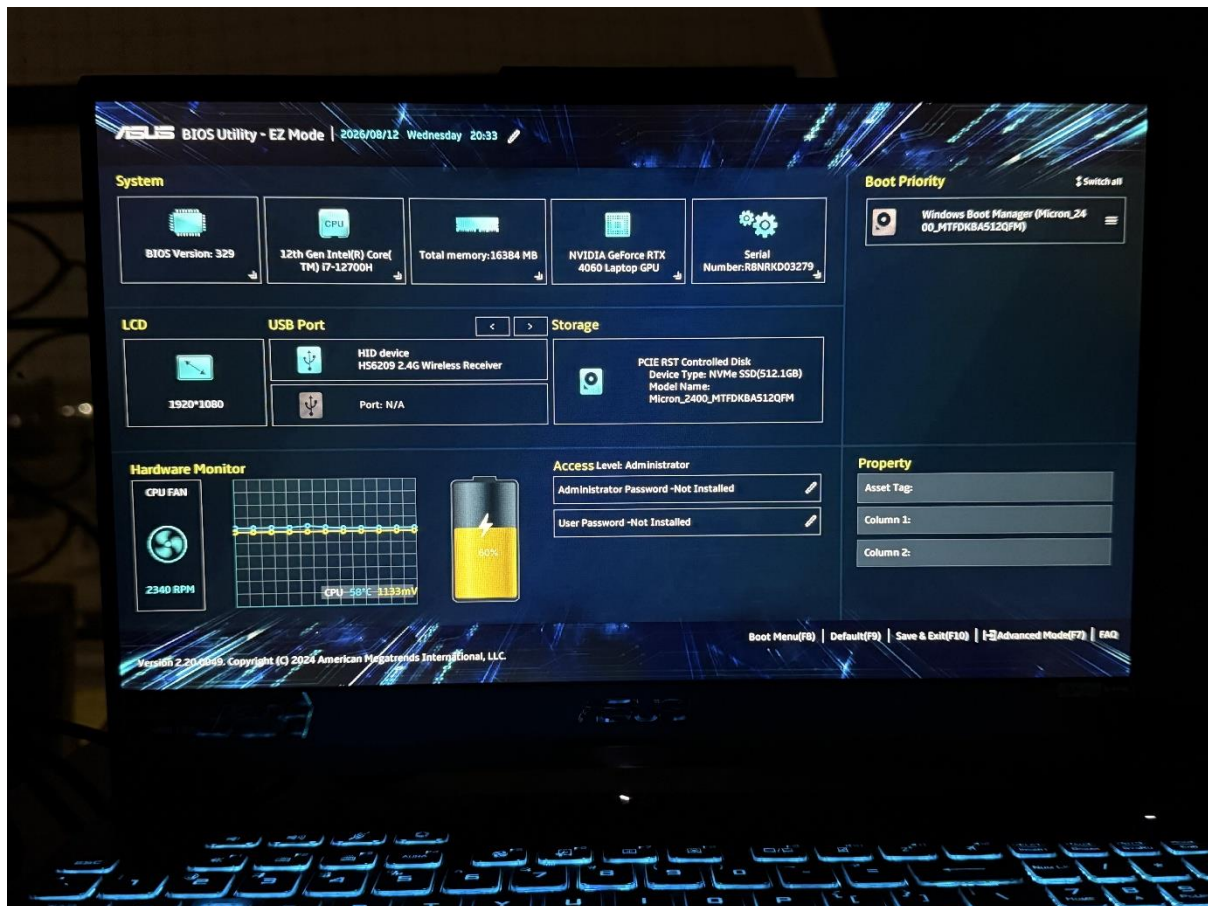


Figure : Main BIOS Setup Utility screen showing the ASUS motherboard manufacturer and BIOS Version 329.

✚ Motherboard Manufacturer: ASUS

✚ BIOS Version: 329

## TASK 4.

❖ You are given a screenshot of a POST error message that says 'CMOS checksum error – Defaults loaded.' Explain what this means and describe how you would resolve this issue in a real system. Think about the CMOS battery and BIOS settings reset.

➤ CMOS Checksum Error:

➤ **Meaning:** This error means the BIOS settings stored in CMOS are corrupted, lost, or have been reset to default values.

➤ **Resolution:**

➤ Enter the BIOS and set the correct date, time, and required settings, then save and restart.

➤ If the error keeps appearing, replace the CMOS battery and configure the BIOS settings again.